

✓ COUNTERSHADED DIVER

Below its distinctive yellow markings, the king penguin has the tuxedo-style plumage pattern typical of penguins: white beneath and dark above. When diving, this pattern offers camouflage from aquatic predators. Seen from below, the pale belly is harder to see against the sunlit surface, and when seen from above, the bird's dark back blends in with the dark of the water below.

yellow markings are due to pigments called carotenoids, which are absent from some penguin species

yellow stripe on lower mandible

yellow breast

